negotiating institution between the Tatmadaw and the EAGs. Throughout the peace process under Thein Sein's administration, the MPC enjoyed direct access and held an influential position in executive decision-making through its individual members, some of whom were ministers, political advisors to the president, and technocrats. Therefore, it could provide political input to the president in making strategic decisions and secure his unwavering support throughout the peace process.

The two major political actors (institutions) on which the MPC placed primary focus in this project were the Tatmadaw and the EAGs. But having strong support from the government did not imply that the MPC received consistent support from the Tatmadaw, because the government peace team's objectives could not entirely reflect those of the Tatmadaw. The former was concerned to sustain the peace process for political reasons, and the latter seemed to place threats to national security at the forefront of the ethnic negotiation project. The Tatmadaw was often reluctant to commit to ethnic peace negotiations. Its hesitancy in following President Thein Sein's orders in December 2011 and January 2012 to halt offensive operations against the Kachin Independence Army (KIA) revealed its basic indisposition to implement President Thein Sein's instructions immediately.

Although the president is the head of the government constitutionally, the real power of President Thein Sein — a former army general himself — over the Tatmadaw was arguable. According to the 2008 Constitution of Myanmar, the Tatmadaw stands as an authoritative institution under the executive, and also constitutes a separate bloc in the parliament.[7] Furthermore, it has six out of eleven influential members in the constitutionally highest decision-making institution, the National Defence and Security Council (NDSC).[8] One of the MPC's major responsibilities therefore was to make sure of the constitutionally powerful Tatmadaw's support for President Thein Sein's peace agenda.

On the other hand, more than twenty individual EAG groups were engaged in the peace talks as members of two ethnic alliance groups, namely the Nationwide Ceasefire Coordination Team (NCCT) and the United Nationalities Federal Council (UNFC). The establishment of a common position among them during collective bargaining has often been problematic. Some have occasionally raised their demands, based on their strategic calculations. For instance, one of the largest armed ethnic armies, the United Wa State Army, asked for a separate state when the Tatmadaw